

MindEase

Mental Health Support App Prototype for Students Using Figma / Stitch

COURSE & INSTRUCTOR

Technical and Business Writing (TBW)

Ms. Nazia Imam

FAST National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences — Karachi Campus

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GROUP MEMBERS

Taha Ahmed 23K-0534

Mirza Sarim Ali Baig 23K-0048

Tuaha Ahmed 23K-0713

Furqan Halari 23K-0556

Umar bin Abid 23K-0009

Sobaan Nayaar 23K-0893

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Abstract

This study investigates the mental health needs of university students at FAST-NUCES Karachi and proposes a digital solution in the form of a mobile application prototype. A survey of 19 students revealed that 94.7% experience stress, yet 89.5% use no mental health app. Key barriers include stigma, lack of culturally relevant tools, and poor app usability. Using a User-Centered Design approach, a high-fidelity prototype called *MindEase* was developed in Stitch — comprising 9 screens designed to be anonymous, culturally relevant, and visually simple.

19

Students surveyed at FAST-NUCES
Karachi

9

High-fidelity screens designed in Stitch

UCD

User-Centered Design methodology

1.0

Introduction

*Understanding the problem
before designing the solution*

Stress is loud. The places to talk about it are quiet.

01

94%

of students report experiencing stress regularly

02

89%

currently use no mental health application

03

57%

prefer to self-manage instead of seeking help

04

84%

cite career uncertainty as their top stressor

A research question and four objectives.

RESEARCH QUESTION

Existing mental health apps often lack simplicity and student-focused features, leading to low engagement. *How can a mental health support application be designed using Figma / Stitch to improve usability and accessibility for students?*

1 Identify key mental health needs of university students

2 Design a low-fidelity wireframe of the application

3 Develop a high-fidelity interactive prototype

4 Evaluate usability through structured user feedback

1.1

Literature Review

*What research tells us about student
mental health and digital solutions*

Mental health challenges in university students.

The Struggle

Academic workload and deadlines
Social isolation and adjustment
Competitive academic environments
Fear of judgment and stigma
Limited access to counseling services

Why Students Stay Silent

Cultural stigma around mental health
Lack of awareness of available resources
Trust issues with support systems
Fear of being judged or labeled

Digital solutions & design principles.

01

M

mHealth Apps

Mood tracking, journaling, and guided exercises available anytime, anywhere. Research shows measurable reductions in anxiety symptoms across student populations.

02

H

HCI Principles

Simplicity, clarity, and reduced cognitive load. Interfaces in this domain must be supportive, intuitive, and non-intimidating to users in vulnerable states.

03

U

User-Centered Design

Continuous feedback and iteration. User comfort and emotional safety are critical factors in any tool that asks people to share what they are feeling.

Why Stitch for prototyping?

01

Rapid prototyping

Build interactive screens without writing code.

02

Iterative design

Adjust quickly based on real user feedback.

03

Real-time collaboration

Whole team contributes from any device.

04

Catches flaws early

Surfaces design problems before development begins.

05

Cost-effective

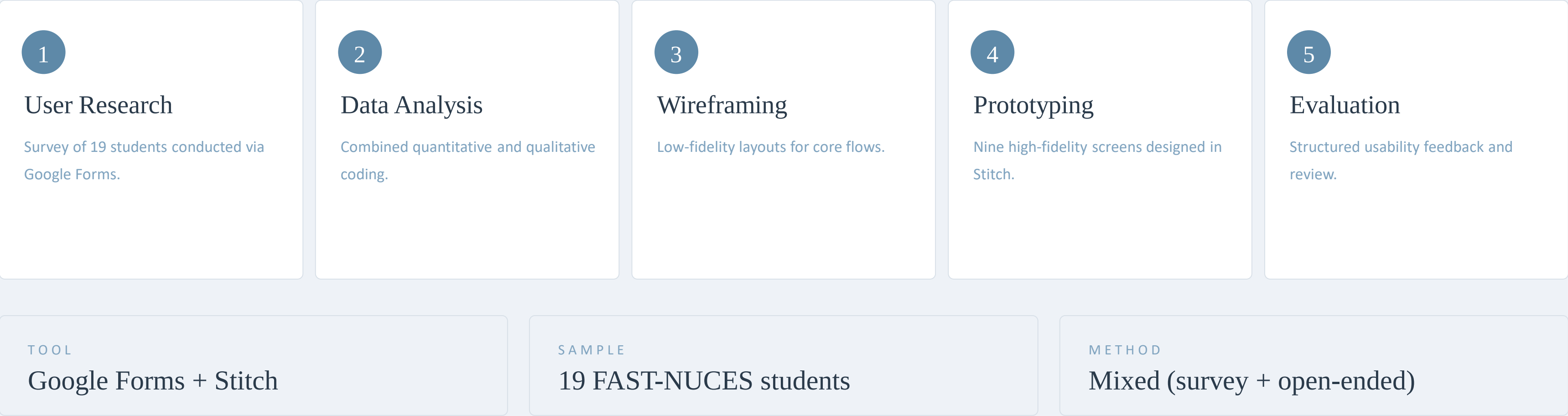
Right-sized for student-led research projects.

2.0

Methodology

How we conducted our research

Research methodology.



3.0

Findings & Discussion

What 19 students told us

Who we surveyed.

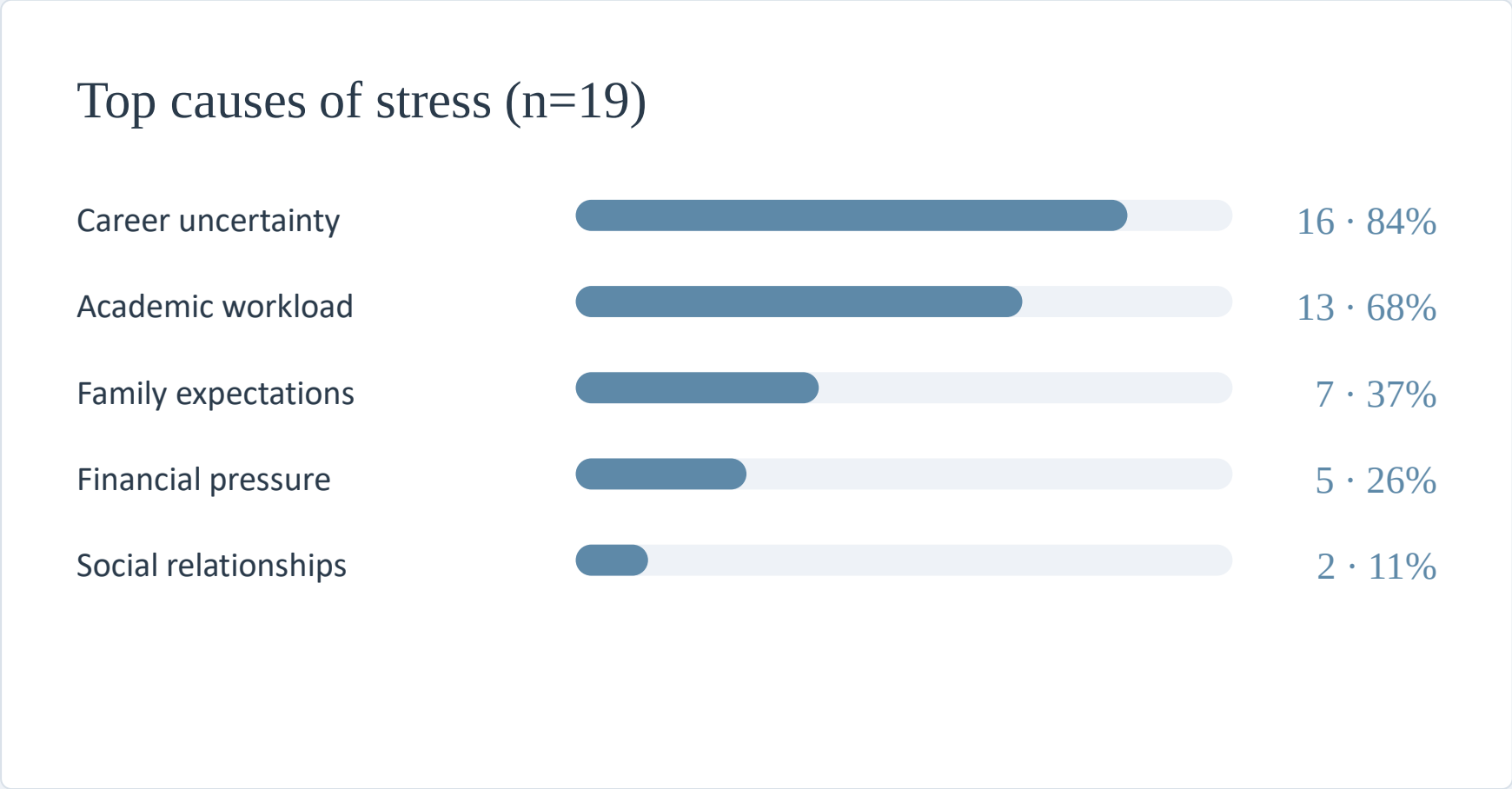
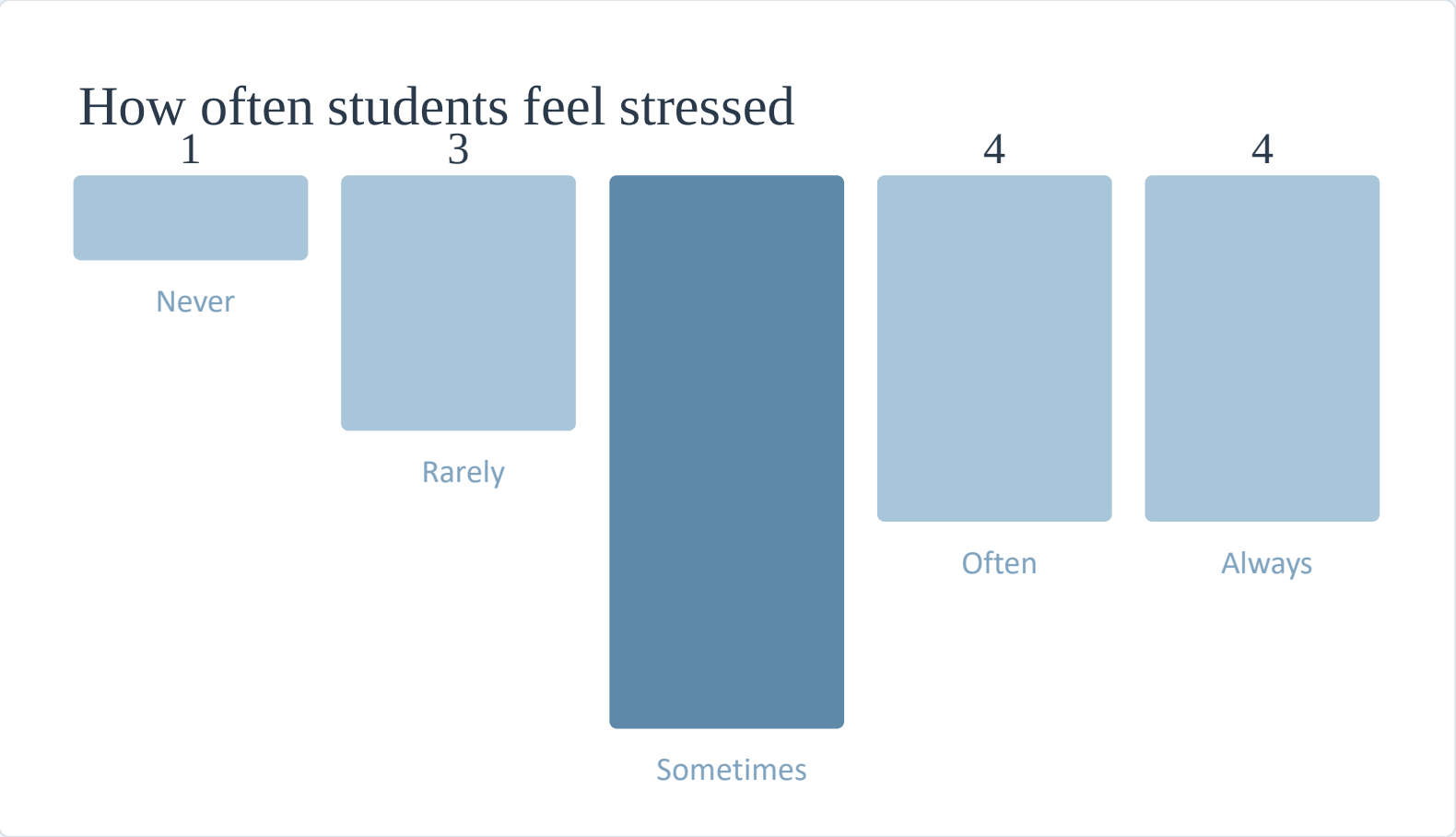
19

Total respondents — all from FAST-NUCES Karachi



3rd or 4th year students	84%
Engineering / Computer Science	95%
FAST-NUCES Karachi campus	100%
Recruited via Google Forms	19 / 19

Stress is universal among students.

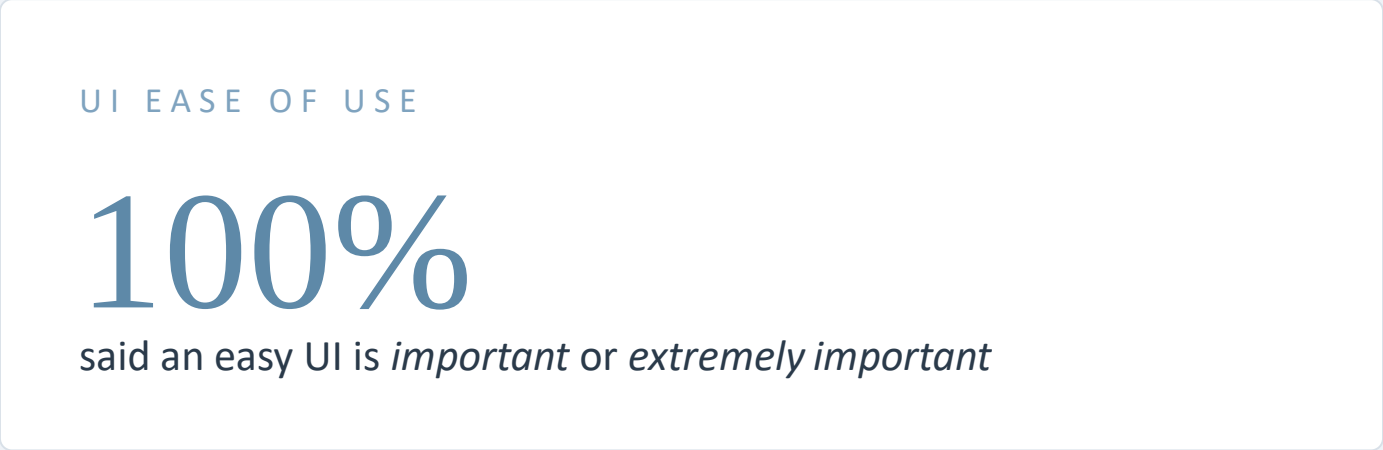
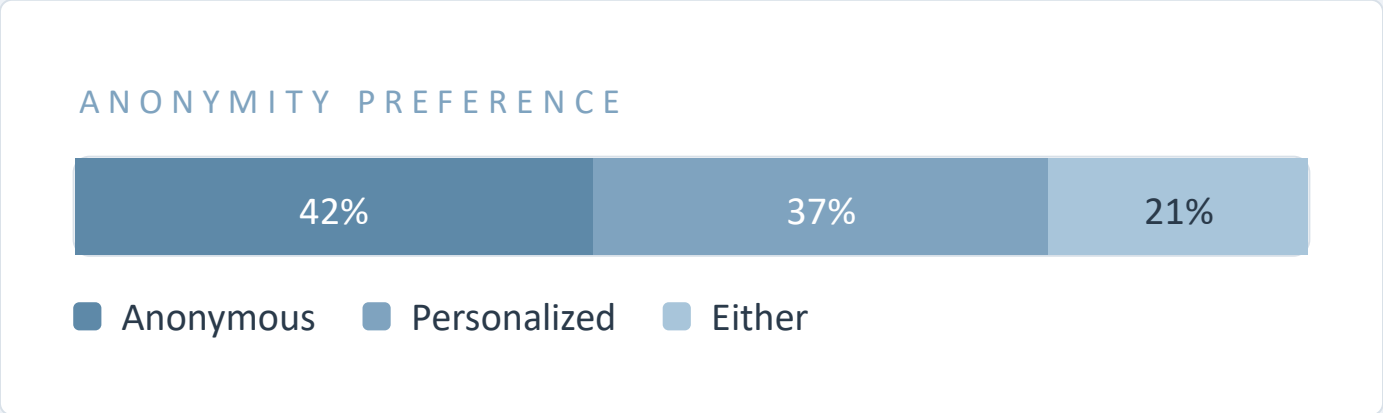


The design gap.



What students actually want.

FEATURE	AVG RANK	LOWER = MORE WANTED
Progress Tracker & Reminders	2.89	
Journaling / Daily Diary	3.00	
Mood Tracking	3.21	
Emergency Contact / Crisis Support	3.21	
Mental Health Resources & Articles	3.47	
Guided Relaxation & Breathing	3.53	



What students said — in their own words.

ANONYMITY



I often feel like I don't have an outlet or someone who could hear me out without judgment.

GENERIC CONTENT



Generic solutions, no room for exclusivity. Having to re-explain my situation every time.

CULTURAL RELEVANCE



If it keeps sending motivational quotes — or Quranic verses or Hadiths.

NORMALIZATION



No one wants to feel special — they just want to feel normal.

MindEase

The Prototype

*Nine high-fidelity screens designed for
Pakistani university students*

PROTOTYPE

Design system.

COLOR PALETTE

Mist
#EEF2F7

Sky
#A8C5DA

Stillwater
#7FA3BF

Deepwater
#5E89A8

Ink
#2A3A4A

ACCENTS

Mint
#B7D4C7

Lavender
#C9C2DD

Sand
#E5D9C3

PRINCIPLES

- MIND BASE — TBM RESEARCH
- Flat and calm — no gradients, no textures
- Anonymous by default
- Culturally relevant content

TYPOGRAPHY

TIMES NEW ROMAN

Breathe with the circle.

Headlines · journal body · quotes

CALIBRI / INTER

Check in · Breathe · Journal

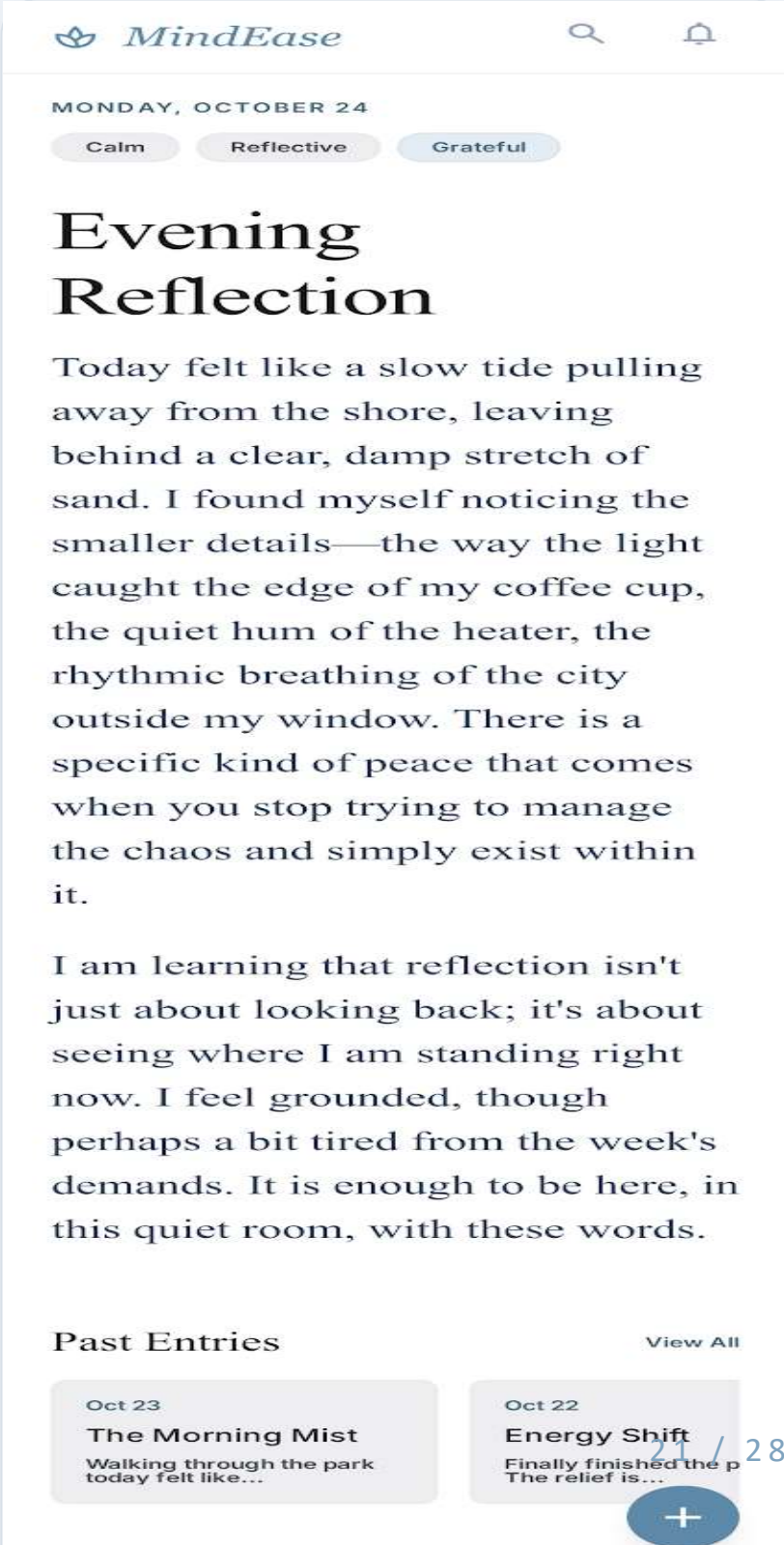
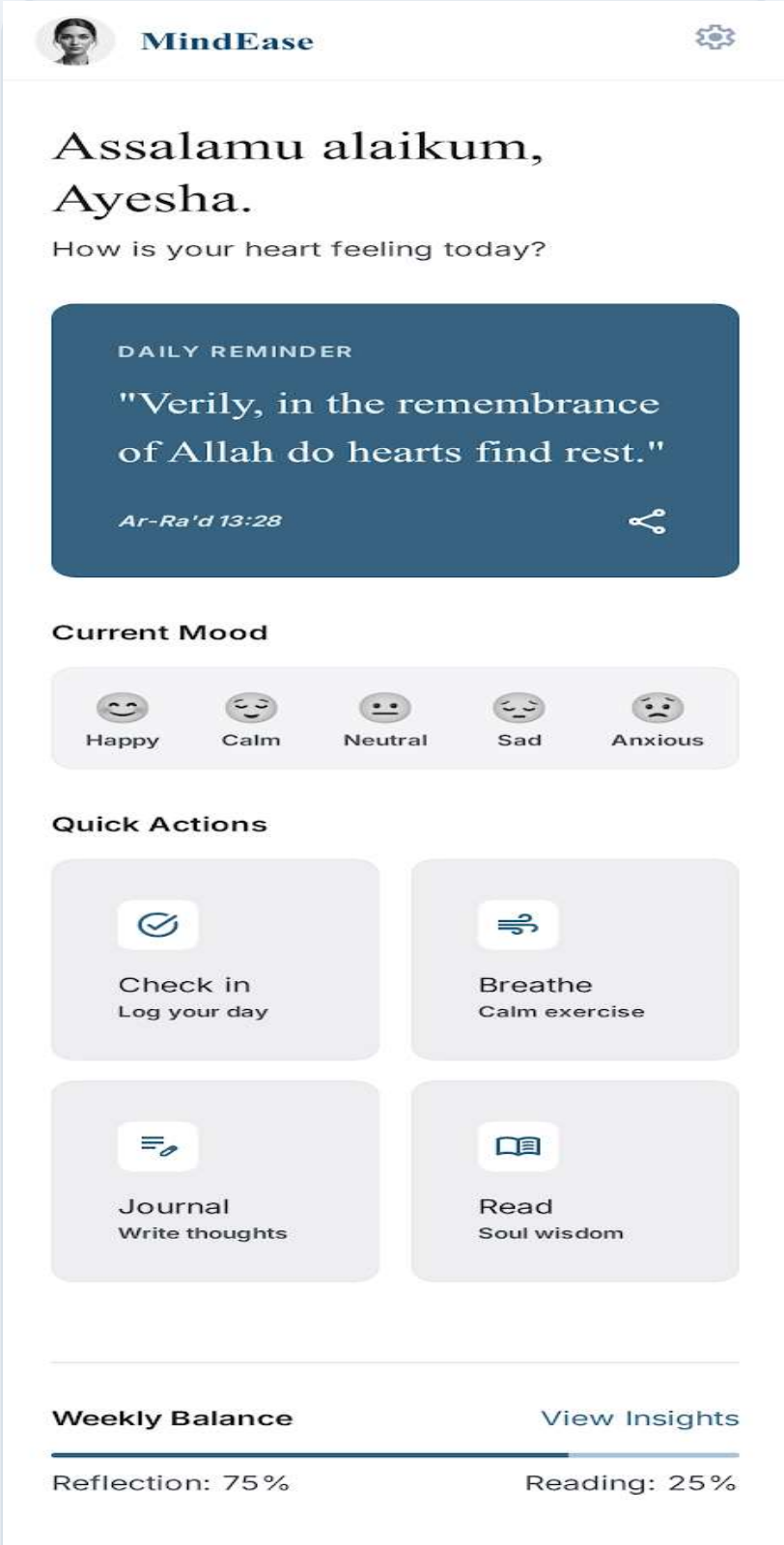
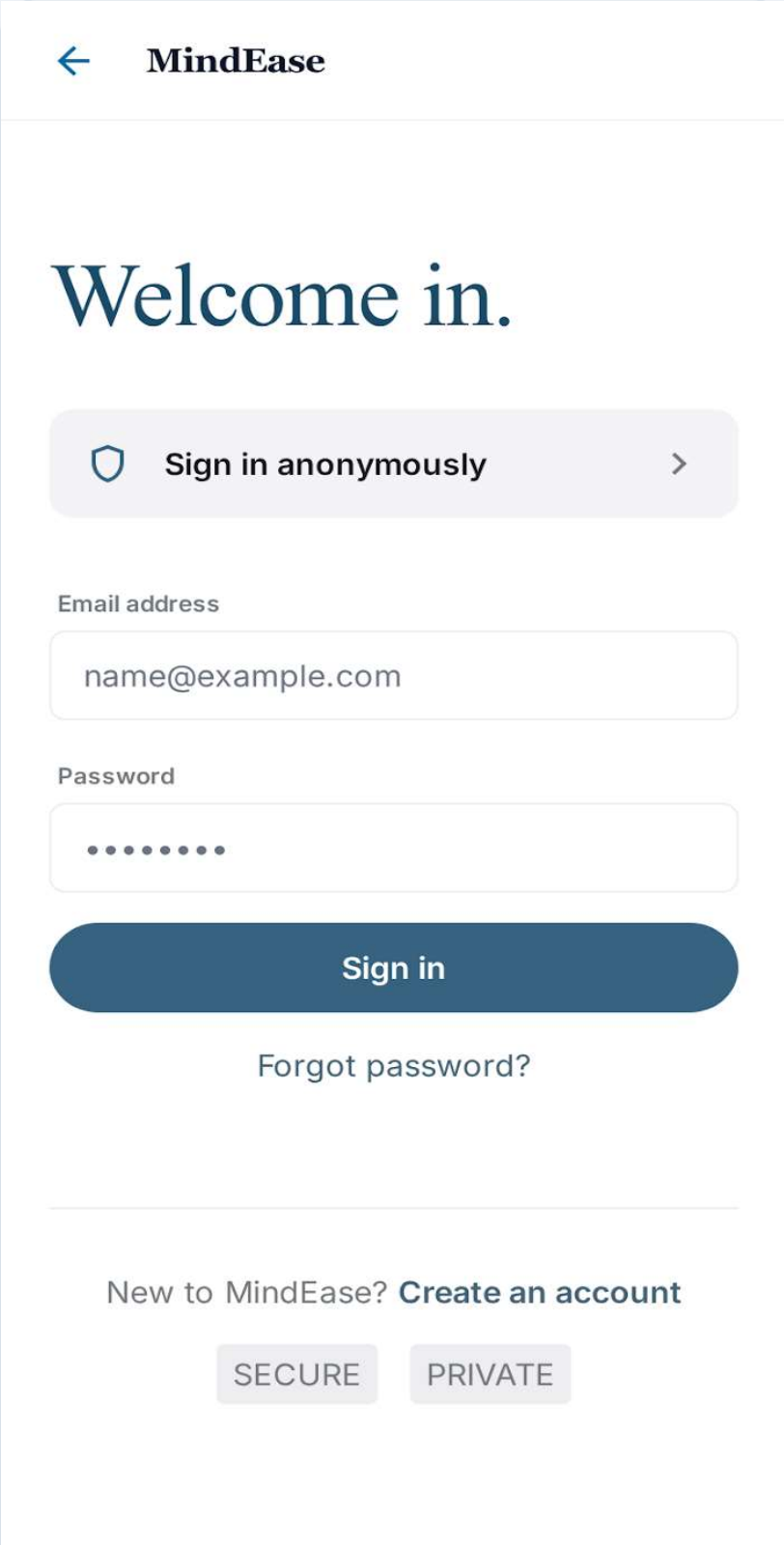
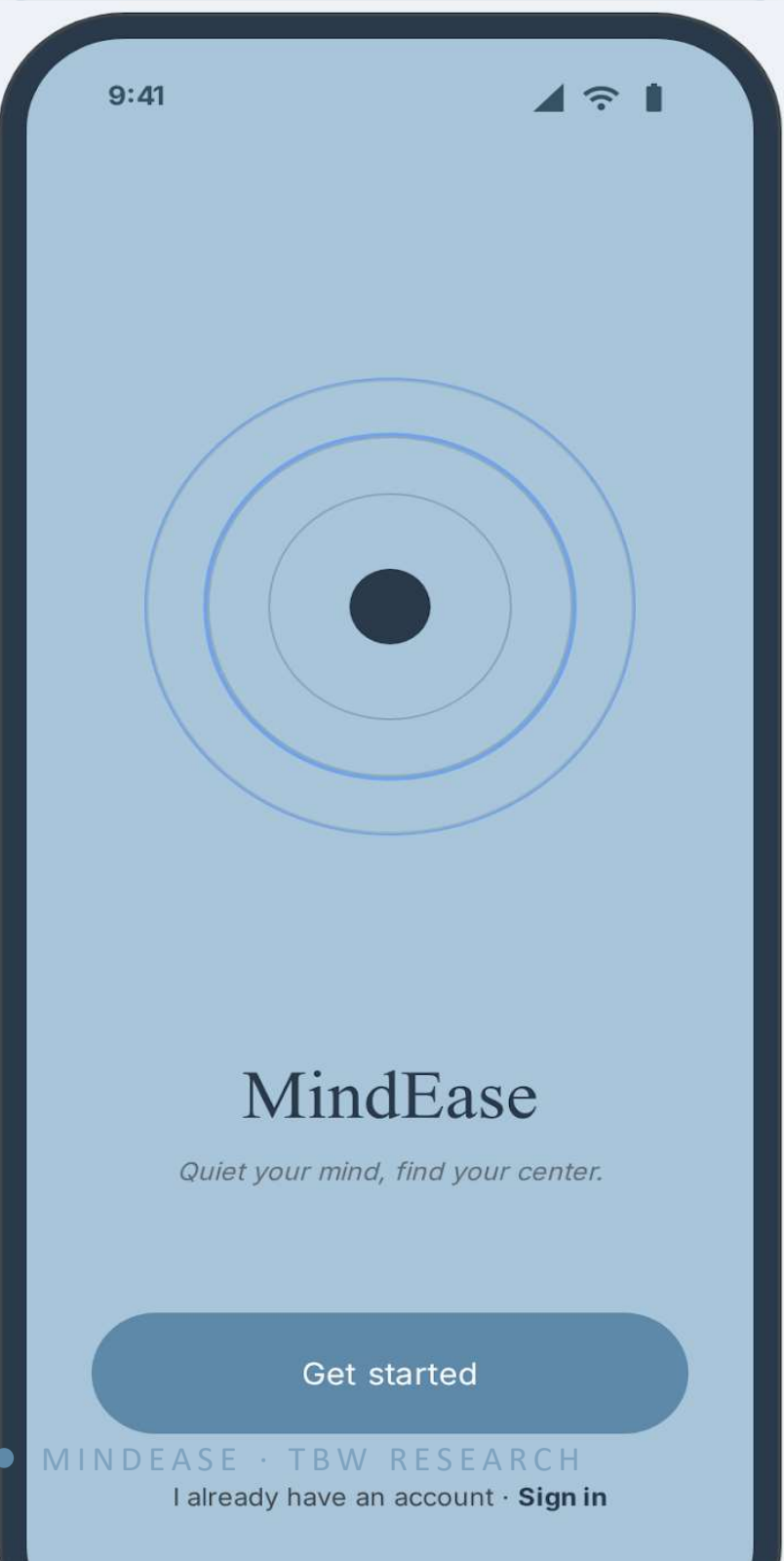
UI labels · buttons · navigation

VOICE

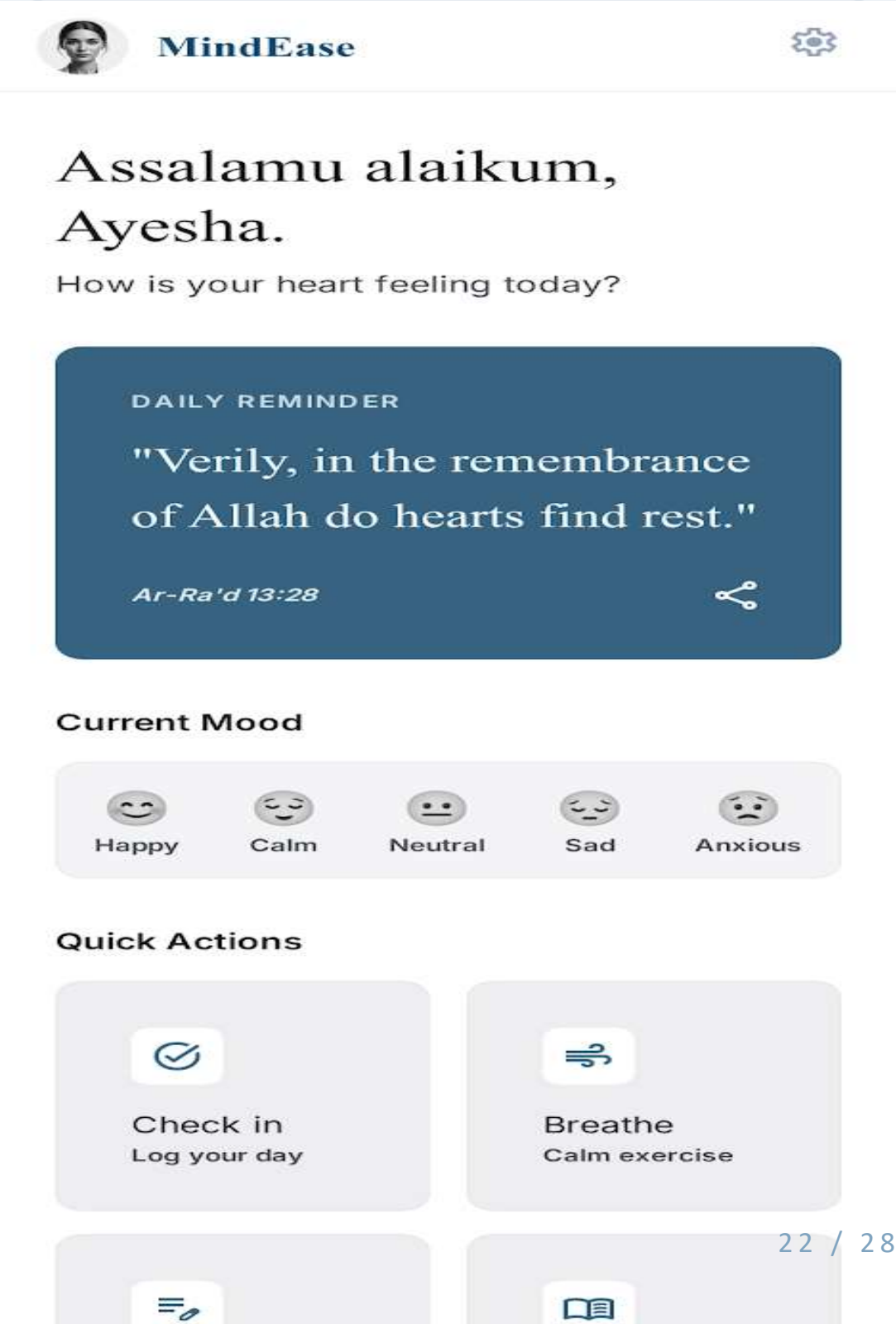
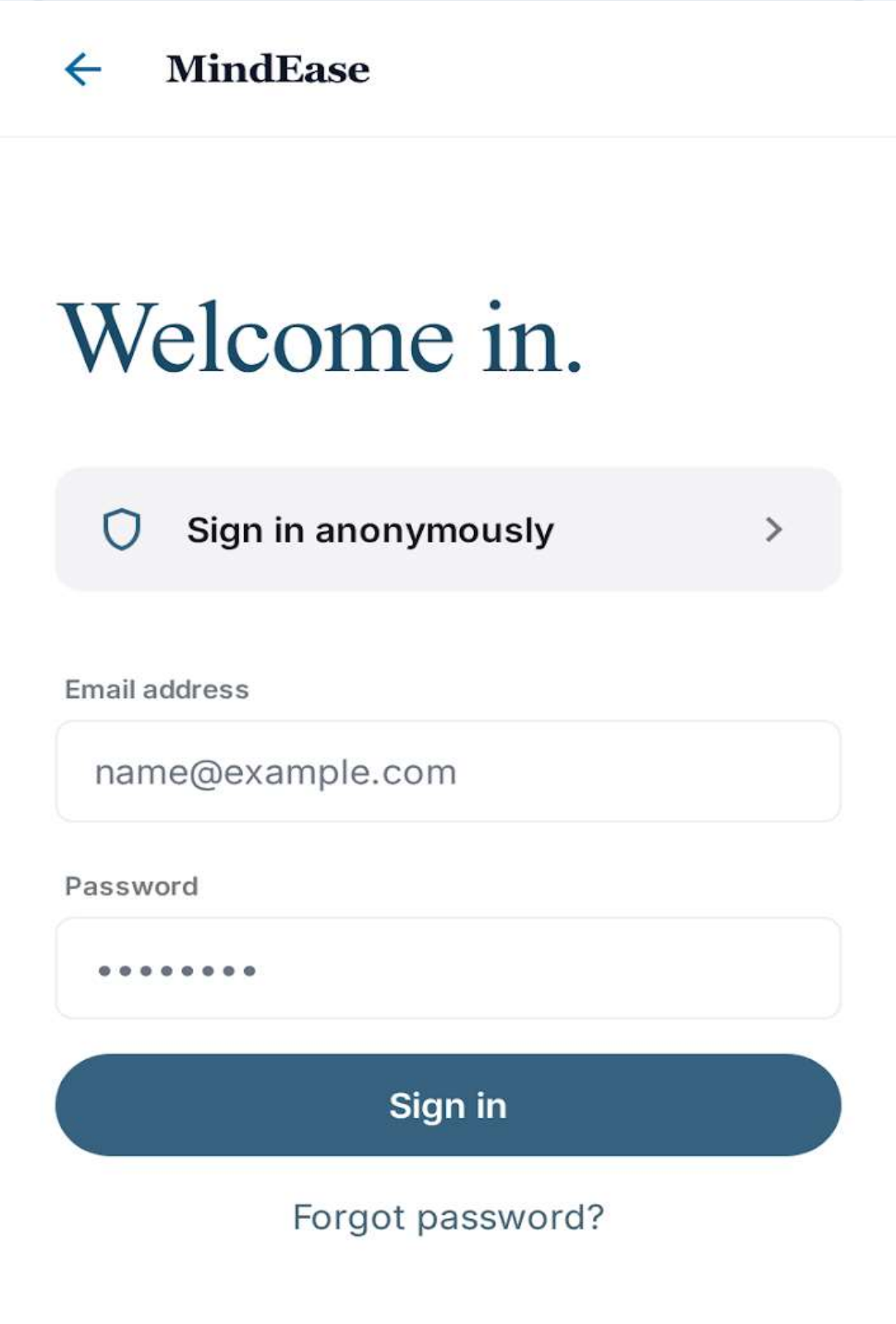
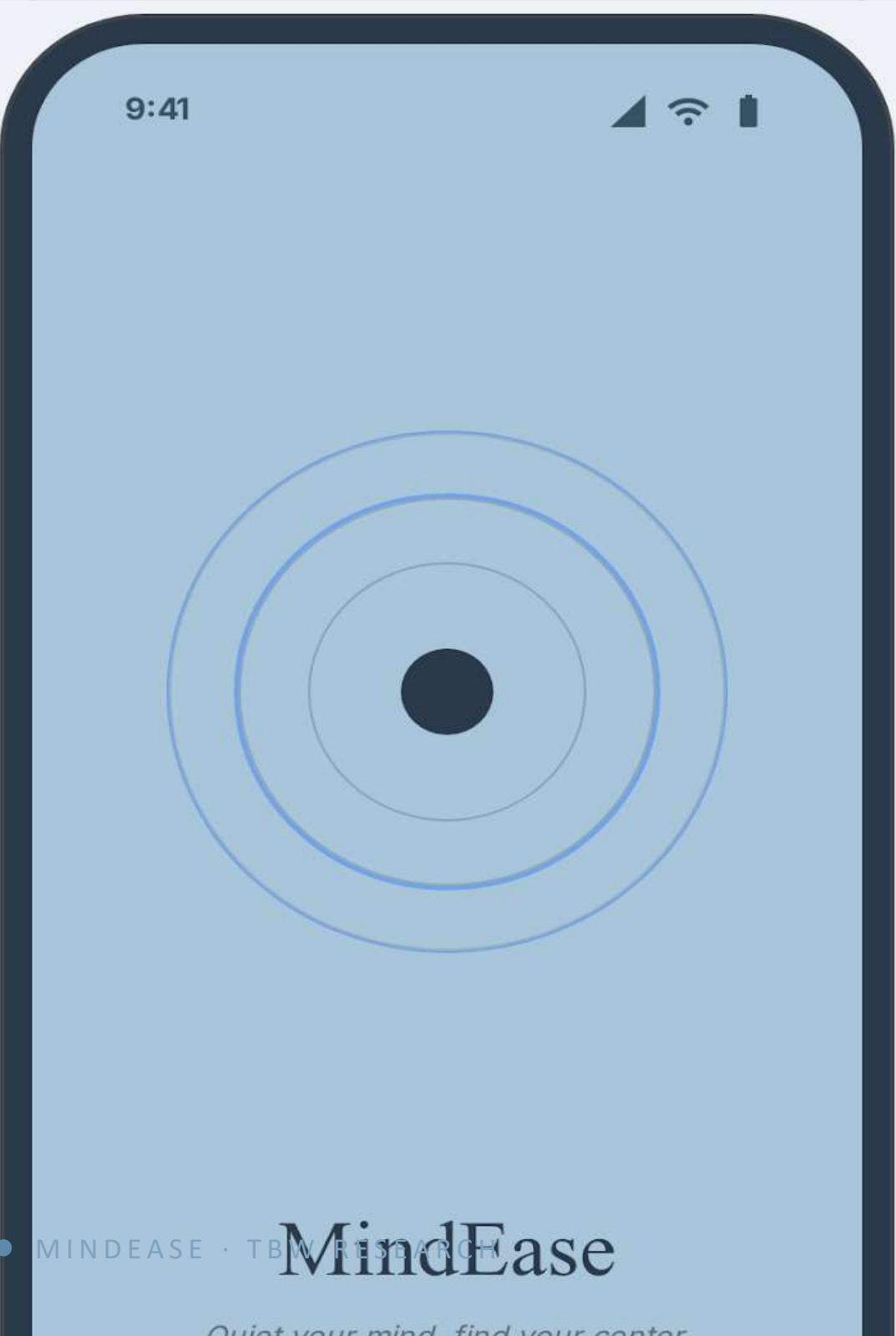
A quiet place for the mind — built for university students, between classes and everything else.

PROTOTYPE

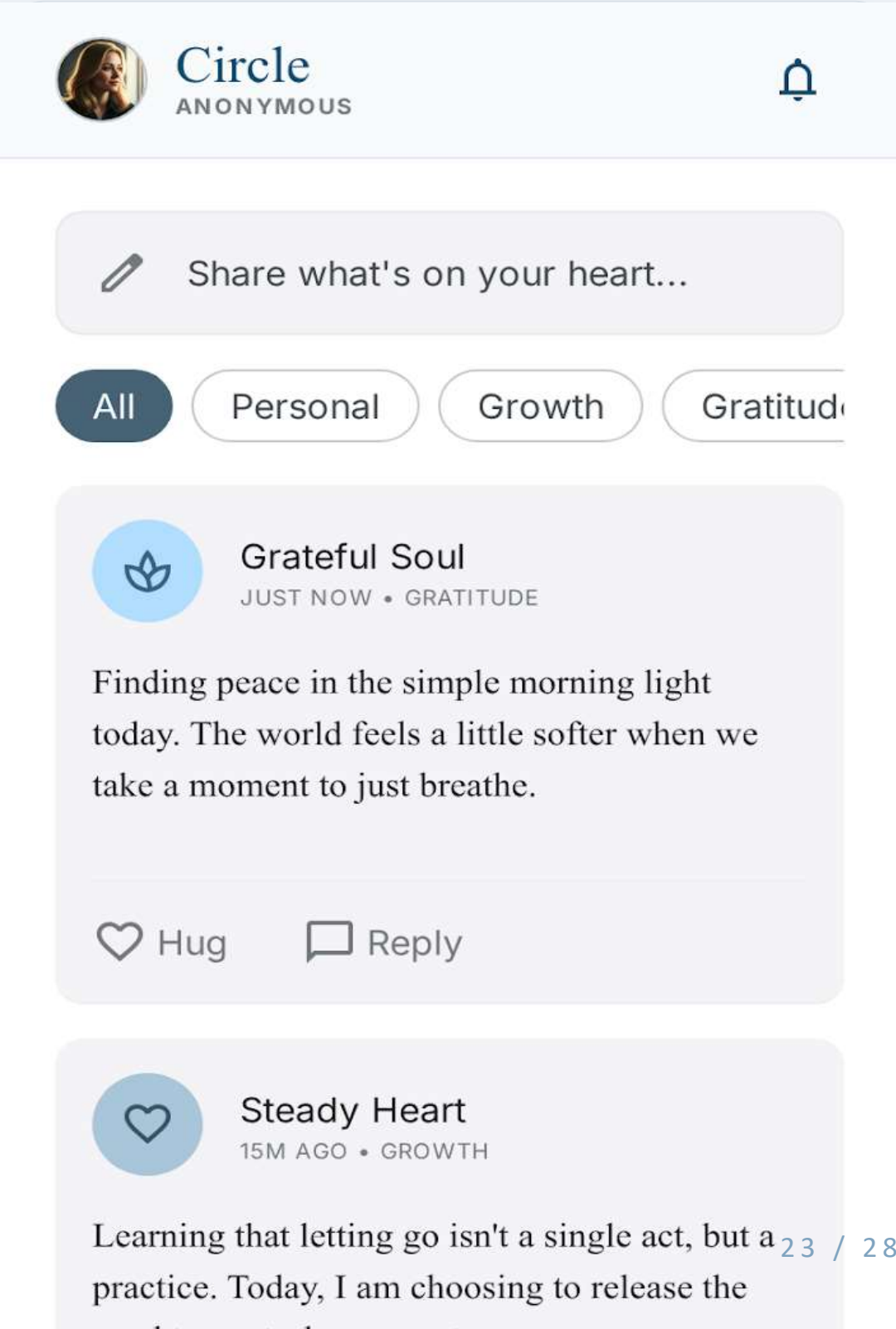
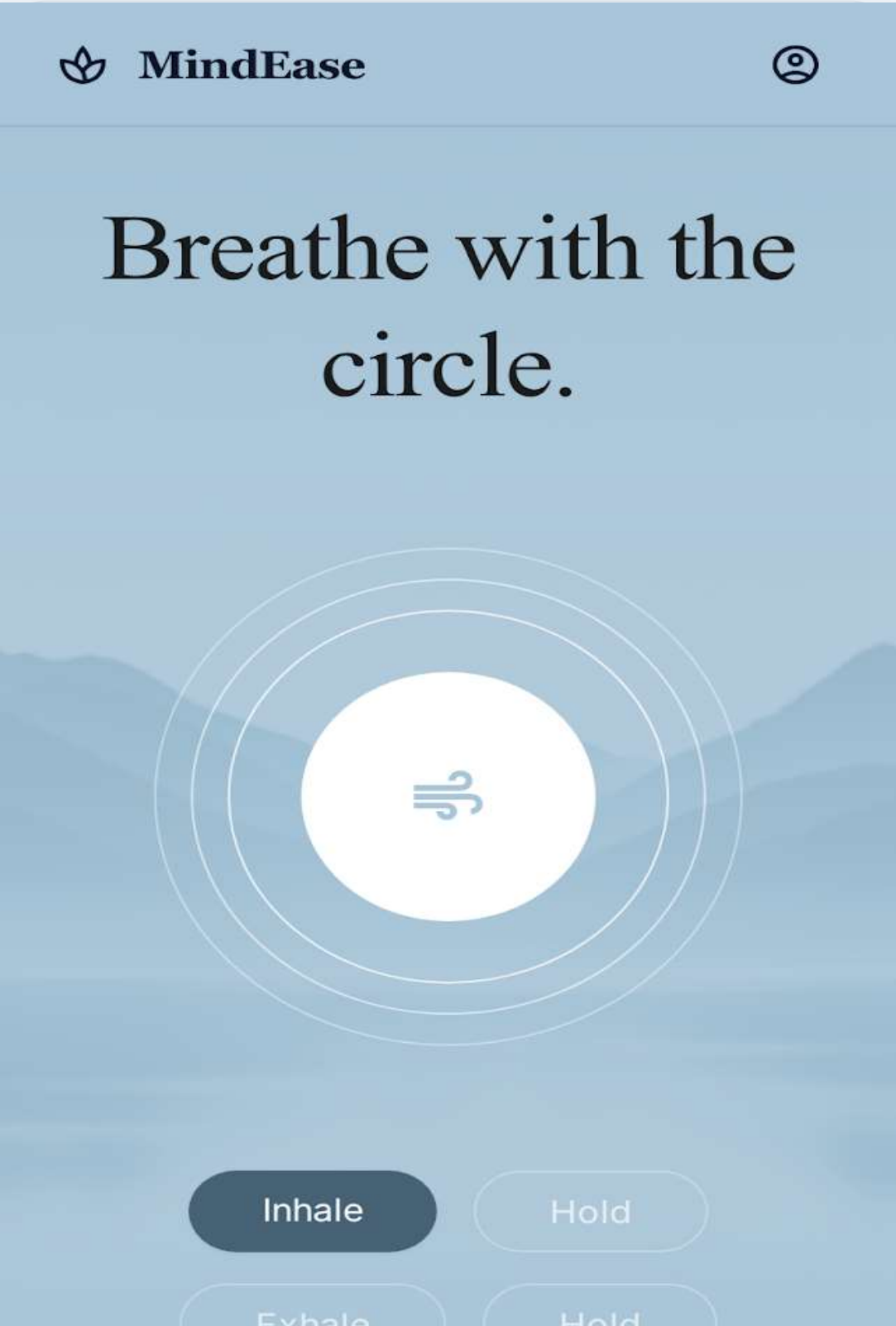
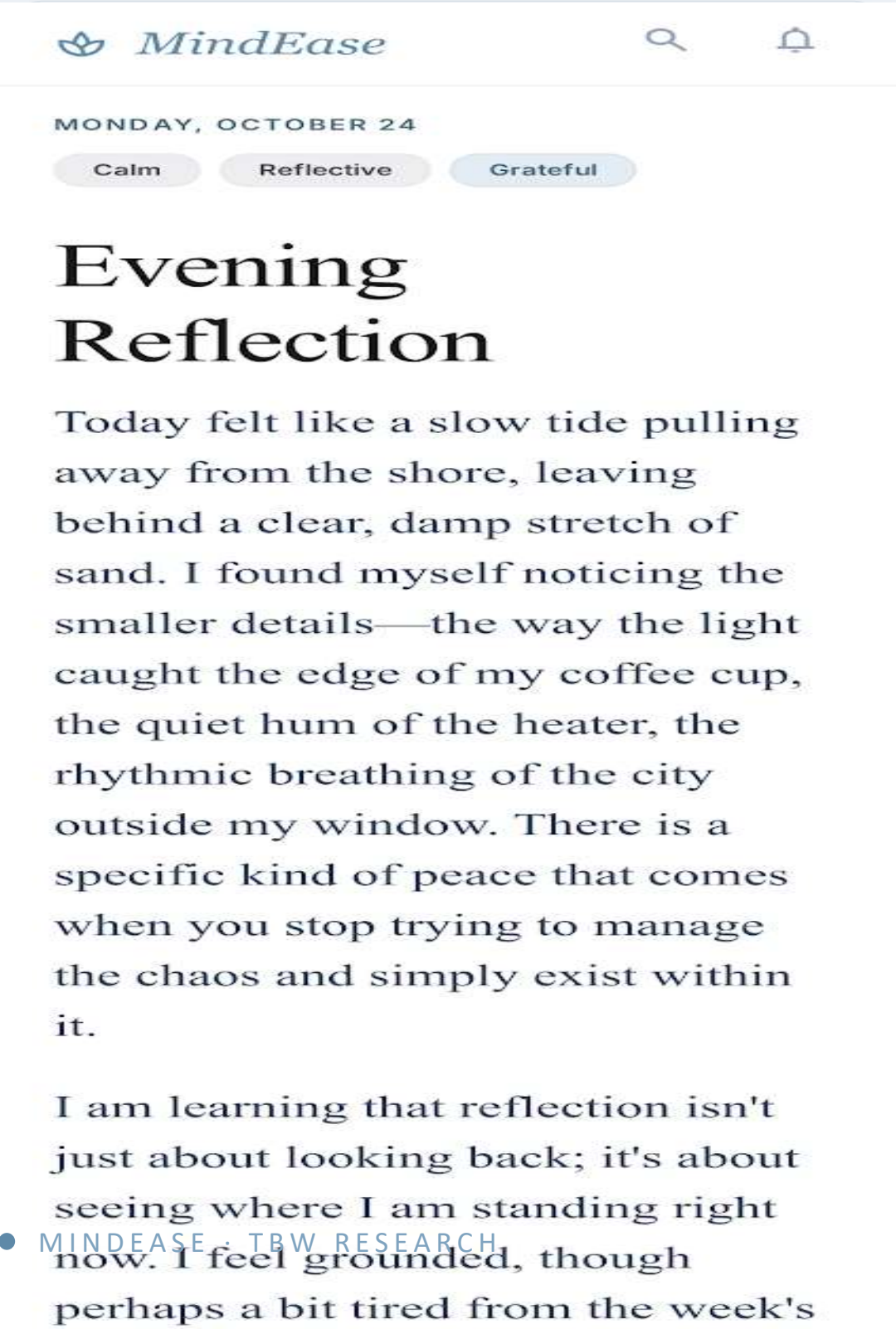
Screens at a glance.



Core screens.



Feature screens.



4.0

Conclusion

*What we achieved
and what comes next*

Conclusion.

This research identified a significant unmet need for a student-centered mental health application at FAST-NUCES. The data confirmed a gap between the demand for support and the supply of usable, culturally grounded tools. *MindEase* is the first response to that gap.

94.7% of students experience stress, but 89.5% use no mental health app.

A clear design gap — demand exists, supply is inadequate.

MindEase prototype directly addresses identified student needs.

Anonymity, cultural relevance, and simplicity are non-negotiable.

The prototype is the foundation for future full development.

Where MindEase goes next.

1 Full Development

Convert the prototype into a functional application with backend integration, secure storage, and account anonymity preserved end-to-end.

2 Expand Research

Conduct usability testing with a larger and more diverse student sample across multiple campuses and faculties.

3 Cultural Expansion

Add Urdu language support and broaden the Islamic content library so daily reminders reflect the user's tradition.

4 Institutional Partnership

Collaborate with the FAST counseling department to surface verified resources and an in-app pathway to professional support.

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Thank you.

Questions & discussion.

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